

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

How did she get started in the PR industry?



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe issues relating to money, in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about jobs and career plans.
- I can discuss things I did and things I was doing.
- I can ask for and receive information about a company.

Ask your partner:

- Would you ever start your own company? Why or why not?
- What would your company do?





Let's Explore!

Janet shares the story of how Polygon **came to be*** with Kristi. How did she **get her start**** in **PR*****?

* To "come to be" means to develop so something exists.

** "To get your start" means to begin a career in a certain field.

*** "PR" is an abbreviation for Public Relations.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Kristi: Ms. Ellison? Do you have a minute?

Janet: Kristi, yes. Come in. Have a seat. What's on your mind?

Kristi: You mentioned that you started Polygon as a start-up company. How did you get into PR?

Janet: Well, I began in non-profit work. I just happened to fall into PR work there, but I didn't really know I was working in that area when I started. I just enjoyed what I was doing, and it was always what I gravitated toward.

Kristi: Why did you want to strike out on your own and become an entrepreneur?

Janet: When I was finishing up grad school, I was interviewing in Chicago. I was hired by a company there to work in communications and marketing. While I was working at the company, I started to get referrals. That's why I decided to open up my own firm.

Kristi: What did you face in the way of challenges to have your own PR firm?

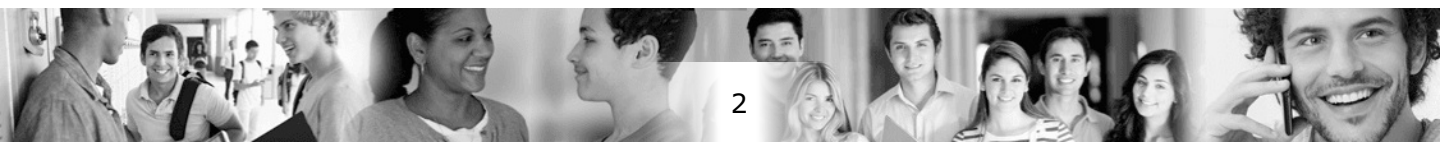
Janet: The referrals moved me away from B2B where the monetary business is, so if I was going to have more financial stability, I knew I would have to build a client list that was going to provide that.

Kristi: How did you feel about that?

Janet: It was difficult. Although I could ask for whatever amount of money I wanted to, I was competing with other firms. So, when I was pitching clients, I sometimes had to lower my rates, which wasn't good financially. I realized early on that I needed to raise capital if I wanted to continue to operate my firm.

Kristi: What else do you need to build a firm and keep it going other than capital?

Janet: First of all, you have to have talent. You need to ask yourself a few questions. Have you got your niche covered? What kind of media are clients currently looking for? How much do you know about those areas? Do your clients need publicity? Are they looking for crisis management? You have to be honest with yourself. You need to know your strengths.





Let's Practice!

What does Janet tell Kristi about? What's B2B?

Instructions: Unscramble the words in order to find out the mystery sentence.

1. as / startup / I / polygon / company / . / a / started

2. did / happened / was / of / work / called / what / lot / during / know / a / I / do / to / non-profit / didn't / but / it / . / I / I / which / PR

3. always / toward / doing / what / was / . / I / gravitated / it / and / I / PR / liked

4. in / grad / was / school / . / up / was / finishing / I / I / interviewing / Chicago / When



Let's Practice!

Excerpts from Polygon's story.

Instructions: Practice the pronunciation of the following phrases. Check the pronunciation with your instructor.

1. You mentioned that you started Polygon as a start-up company. How did you get your start in the PR industry?
2. When I was finishing up grad school, I was interviewing in Chicago. I was hired by a company to do their communications and marketing.
3. I mean I could ask for whatever amount of money I wanted when the clients came to me, but when you're pitching clients, it's a competitive situation and you have to cut your rates which isn't good financially.
4. It's a given that you have to have talent. Also, do you have your niche covered? Do you know the kind of media that your client is looking for? Do you have clients that need publicity, or another type of PR, such as crisis management?





Extension Activity

Find out about an entrepreneur.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Do you know of any entrepreneurs? If not, research one.
- While you do your research note some information on the entrepreneur, then think of 10 questions to ask them.
- Once you have your 10 questions, think of a possible answer for each one.
- If possible, talk to the actual person or send them an e-mail with your questions.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I identify an entrepreneur.

☐ ☐

I write questions appropriate to ask an entrepreneur.

☐ ☐

I think and write down possible answers.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- start-up company** (noun): a new small business
e.g. You mentioned that you started Polygon as a start-up company.
- non-profit work** (noun): work where the money earned is used to help people instead of making a profit
e.g. I began working in non-profit work when I was younger.
- to gravitate toward(s)** (verb): to be interested in something and become involved with it
e.g. I just enjoyed what I was doing, and it was always what I gravitated toward.
- monetary** (adjective): relating to money
e.g. The referrals moved me away from B2B where the monetary business is.
- capital** (noun): money used to start a business or to produce more wealth
Example: I realized early on that I needed to raise capital.
- entrepreneur** (noun): someone who starts a new business
e.g. Why did you want to strike out on your own and become an entrepreneur?
- niche** (noun): a job or activity that is very suitable for you
Example: Have you got your niche covered?





Learning Points

The Simple Past and The Past Continuous Tenses

When you talk about events in your life, it is common to use a mixture of tenses. This allows you to convey a variety of timelines and action sequences.

You use the **Simple Past tense** to talk about past events of different kinds. It can be: short actions that finished quickly, repeated events or events of a longer duration in the past.

- I **did** a lot of work.
- They **hired** me right away.
- I **needed** to find a quick fix to the problem.

You use the **Past Continuous tense** to talk about an event that was happening at a time before now.

- I **was interviewing** in the city.
- I **was getting** anxious.
- I **was starting** to get frustrated.

Simple Past	Past Continuous
new event	event that is already in progress
events happened after one another	events happened at the same time
just mentioning an event	emphasizing the progress of an event





Learning Points

Asking for and Giving Information

When you want to learn more about a company, you can talk to a professional to get more information. The kinds of questions you ask the professional will serve as clues for them to know what kind of information and/or answer you are looking for.

You can ask for:

- background information
- reasons
- examples
- ideas
- suggestions
- opinions

Remember that when asking for information you can use **Wh- words**.

Question Word	Use
<i>Who</i>	used to ask for a suggestion or an opinion about someone
<i>What</i>	used to ask for background information, examples or ideas
<i>When</i>	used to ask for examples
<i>Why</i>	used to ask for reasons
<i>How</i>	used to ask for a variety of things

Examples:

- *What were the biggest challenges?*
- *How did you get your start in the industry?*
- *When did you realize you wanted to start your company?*
- *How do you feel about that?*

